KINGDOM LIFE MINISTRY

The Blood on the Door

Passover: His Appointed Time, Fulfilled in Yahshua, Kept by His People

A Midrash Study on Pesach, Leviticus 23:5

Scripture quoted from the World English Bible, divine name rendered YHWH, Elohim, and Adonai, with Yahshua and Messiah restored. Torah is referred to throughout as the instructions of YHWH.

THE HEART OF IT

Passover is the first appointed time on YHWH's yearly calendar, and the first thing it teaches is that judgment passes over the house that is covered by the blood of the lamb.

Yahshua is that Lamb. He was not a picture added to Passover later. Passover was written as a picture of him from the beginning. And the people he called to keep it were never only one bloodline. From the very first night, the door was open to the stranger who joined himself to YHWH.

HOW TO READ THIS HANDOUT

Every claim is marked by how firmly the text gives it. **Commanded** means the instruction is written plainly. **Interpretive** means it is a reasonable reading of the text that Scripture does not state outright. **Conviction** means it is how we at Kingdom Life walk it out. Where Scripture stops speaking, we do not call our reading a commandment.

SECTION I

The Appointed Time Itself

> *In the first month, on the fourteenth day of the month in the evening, is YHWH's Passover.*
> **LEVITICUS 23:5**

Leviticus 23 calls these days **the set feasts of YHWH** (23:2). The Hebrew is *moedim*, appointed times, from *ya'ad*, to appoint or fix a meeting. These are not Israel's holidays that YHWH tolerates. He says plainly, **these are my set feasts**. Passover is the first of the yearly appointments, and it falls on the fourteenth day of the first month, which Scripture names *Abib* (Exodus 13:4; Deuteronomy 16:1).

YHWH reset Israel's calendar on the night he brought them out: **This month shall be to you the beginning of months** (Exodus 12:2). Redemption became the starting point of the year. Before anything else on his calendar, there is the blood.

The Words

- ***Pesach (H6453).*** Passover, the name of the feast and of the lamb itself (Exodus 12:21). It comes from the verb *pasach* (H6452), to pass over.
- ***Pasach (H6452).*** To pass over, to leap over, to spare. Isaiah 31:5 uses the same verb for YHWH standing guard: as birds hovering, he will protect Jerusalem, he will **pass over** and preserve it. The word is not only about the destroyer moving on. It is about YHWH covering the house.
- ***Pascha (G3957).*** The Greek form, used in the Septuagint for Pesach and throughout the New Testament. When Paul writes **Messiah, our Passover**, the word is *pascha* (1 Corinthians 5:7).
- ***Ben ha'arbayim.*** Literally between the two evenings (Exodus 12:6; Leviticus 23:5), the window in which the lamb was killed on the fourteenth. The WEB renders it simply as at evening.
- ***Moed (H4150).*** An appointed time, an appointed meeting. The same word is used for the tent of meeting, the ohel moed. An appointed time is a meeting place in time.

SECTION II

The Night in Egypt: Exodus 12

Read Exodus 12:1-14 out loud and notice how much detail YHWH gives. Each household took a lamb on the tenth day of the month (12:3). It had to be without blemish, a male of the first year (12:5). They kept it until the fourteenth and killed it at evening (12:6). They put its blood on the two doorposts and on the lintel (12:7), using a bunch of hyssop (12:22). They roasted it with fire and ate it that night with unleavened bread and bitter herbs (12:8), dressed and ready to leave, with sandals on their feet and staff in hand (12:11). Not one bone was to be broken (12:46).

> *The blood shall be to you for a token on the houses where you are. When I see the blood, I will pass over you, and no plague will be on you to destroy you when I strike the land of Egypt.*
> **EXODUS 12:13**

The Hebrew word for token is *oth* (H226), a sign. It is the same word used for the rainbow, for circumcision, and for the Sabbath. Notice who the sign was for: **when I see the blood**. The Israelites inside the house could not see the doorposts. They were trusting that YHWH saw what they could not. What saved the house was not how good the family was. It was whether the blood was on the door.

> **SAY IT PLAINLY**
>
> There were Israelites in Egypt who were idol worshippers (Joshua 24:14; Ezekiel 20:7-8), and there were Egyptians who feared the word of YHWH (Exodus 9:20). **On Passover night the question was not whose bloodline you were from. It was whose blood was on your door.**

> *This day shall be a memorial for you. You shall keep it as a feast to YHWH. You shall keep it as a feast throughout your generations by an ordinance forever.*
> **EXODUS 12:14**

Zikkaron (H2146) is a memorial, a reminder. *Chuqqat olam* is an ordinance forever. YHWH attached the word forever to this night before Israel had ever walked out of Egypt. **Commanded.**

SECTION III

The Lamb of Elohim

> *The next day, he saw Yahshua coming to him, and said, "Behold, the Lamb of Elohim, who takes away the sin of the world!"*
> **JOHN 1:29**

The Greek word John uses is *amnos* (G286), the same word the Septuagint uses for the lambs of the daily offering and the lamb led to the slaughter in Isaiah 53:7. In Revelation the word shifts to *arnion* (G721), the Lamb standing as though it had been slain (Revelation 5:6). The first thing anyone in the Gospel of John says about Yahshua's identity in public is that he is the Lamb.

How Precisely He Matched the Passover Lamb

- **Without blemish.** The Passover lamb had to be perfect (Exodus 12:5). Peter says we were redeemed with precious blood, as of a lamb without blemish or spot, the blood of Messiah (1 Peter 1:19). Pilate said three times that he found no fault in him (John 18:38; 19:4, 6). **Stated in the text.**
- **Not a bone broken.** The soldiers broke the legs of the two men crucified with him, but when they came to Yahshua he was already dead, and they did not break his legs. John says this happened so the Scripture would be fulfilled, a bone of him will not be broken (John 19:32-36; Exodus 12:46; Psalm 34:20). **Stated in the text.**
- **Hyssop.** Hyssop applied the blood to the doors in Egypt (Exodus 12:22). A sponge of sour wine was put on hyssop and lifted to his mouth on the stake (John 19:29). **Stated in the text; the link is interpretive.**
- **The fourteenth day.** The lamb died on the fourteenth, before the high day began at sunset (Leviticus 23:5-7). John says Yahshua was crucified on the Preparation of the Passover (John 19:14), and the next day was a high day, a Sabbath (John 19:31). **Stated in the text.**
- **Set apart before the day.** The lamb was taken on the tenth day and kept until the fourteenth (Exodus 12:3, 6). Yahshua came to Bethany six days before the Passover and entered Jerusalem the next day (John 12:1, 12). **Interpretive.** The pattern is striking, but Scripture does not name the triumphal entry as the lamb being taken, so we hold it loosely.

> *Purge out the old yeast, that you may be a new lump, even as you are unleavened. For indeed Messiah, our Passover, has been sacrificed in our place.*
> **1 CORINTHIANS 5:7**

Paul does not say Messiah is like a Passover. He says **Messiah is our Passover**. The lamb in Egypt pointed forward. The Lamb at Golgotha is the one it pointed to. That is why we keep the appointed time: not to add anything to his blood, but to remember it the way he told his people to remember.

SECTION IV

The Week of the Cross

We hold that Yahshua was crucified on a Wednesday and laid in the tomb before sunset, as the high Sabbath of Unleavened Bread began. That week had two Sabbaths: the high day of the fifteenth (John 19:31) and the weekly

seventh day Sabbath. The women bought spices after one Sabbath (Mark 16:1) and prepared them before resting on the other (Luke 23:56). This gives the full three days and three nights Yahshua named as the only sign he would give (Matthew 12:40), and the tomb was already empty when the women came early on the first day. **Conviction, built on the texts named.** Many believers hold a Friday crucifixion; we invite them to lay these verses side by side.

Did Yahshua Eat the Passover Meal?

We hold that the meal Yahshua ate with his disciples on the night he was betrayed was a last supper before Passover, not the Passover meal itself. John places that meal **before the feast of the Passover** (John 13:1). The morning after it, the religious leaders would not enter Pilate's headquarters so that they would not be defiled, **but might eat the Passover** (John 18:28). The Passover had not been eaten yet. And Yahshua died on the Preparation of the Passover (John 19:14).

> *He said to them, "I have earnestly desired to eat this Passover with you before I suffer, for I tell you, I will no longer by any means eat of it until it is fulfilled in Elohim's Kingdom."*
> **LUKE 22:15-16**

Luke 22:15-16 is the verse most often raised against this. We read it as Yahshua expressing a desire he would not fulfill that year, because he himself would be the Lamb before the Passover came. **Conviction.** To be honest with the reader: the first three Gospels call that evening the first day of Unleavened Bread and speak of preparing the Passover (Matthew 26:17; Mark 14:12; Luke 22:7-8), and believers have wrestled with how John and the other Gospels fit together for centuries. Study the passages for yourself. What all four Gospels agree on is the part that matters most: **he died as the Lamb at the time of Passover.**

> *For as often as you eat this bread and drink this cup, you proclaim Adonai's death until he comes.*
> **1 CORINTHIANS 11:26**

At that supper Yahshua took bread and the cup and said, **do this in memory of me** (Luke 22:19; 1 Corinthians 11:24-25). The Greek word is *anamnesis* (G364), remembrance. It carries the same idea as the *zikkaron* of Exodus 12:14. Passover was always a memorial. Yahshua showed his disciples what it would now remember.

SECTION V

Keeping Passover Without the Temple

This is the question every believer who wants to keep the appointed times has to answer honestly. There is no temple, no altar, and no Levitical priesthood serving in Jerusalem. Most of us do not live in the land. So what does obedience look like?

> *You may not sacrifice the Passover within any of your gates which YHWH your Elohim gives you; but at the place which YHWH your Elohim shall choose to cause his name to dwell in, there you shall sacrifice the Passover at evening, at the going down of the sun, at the season that you came out of Egypt.*
> **DEUTERONOMY 16:5-6**

This is the plain answer to the lamb. In Egypt, every house killed its own lamb. But once Israel entered the land, YHWH limited the Passover sacrifice to **the place he would choose**. The Hebrew verb is *zabach* (H2076), to slaughter as a sacrifice. Deuteronomy 12:13-14 says the same thing about every offering: not in any place you see,

but in the place YHWH chooses. **Commanded.**

> **WHAT THAT MEANS FOR US**
>
> We do not sacrifice a Passover lamb today, and we do not invent a substitute sacrifice. Doing it outside the place he chose would be disobedience, not devotion.
>
> We do not need to. **Messiah, our Passover, has been sacrificed** (1 Corinthians 5:7). He entered once for all into the holy place, not with the blood of goats and calves, but with his own blood (Hebrews 9:12). The sacrifice is not missing. It is finished.

What Still Stands in Every Home

Strip away what requires the altar and look at what Scripture attaches to the memorial itself. None of these require a temple or the land:

- **Remember the night.** It is a memorial, a *zikkaron*, throughout your generations (Exodus 12:14; Deuteronomy 16:3). **Commanded.**
- **Tell your children.** When your children ask what this means, you tell them what YHWH did (Exodus 12:26-27; 13:8, 14). **Commanded.** This is a father's assignment at the table.
- **Remember the Lamb.** Yahshua said do this in memory of me (Luke 22:19), and Paul wrote to believers in Corinth, far from Jerusalem, as often as you eat this bread and drink this cup (1 Corinthians 11:26). **Commanded** by Yahshua; Scripture does not fix how often.
- **Keep the feast with sincerity and truth.** Paul tells the Corinthians, **let's keep the feast** (1 Corinthians 5:8). The Greek *heortazo* (G1858) means to keep a feast, to celebrate it. He wrote that to a mostly Gentile assembly outside the land. **Stated in the text.**
- **Examine yourself.** Before the bread and the cup, a man is to examine himself (1 Corinthians 11:28). **Commanded.**

What Some Households Choose to Do

Some families eat a roasted lamb meal with unleavened bread and bitter herbs on Passover evening, the same foods named in Exodus 12:8, as a remembrance at the table. That is a meal, not a sacrifice, and it should never be called one. Scripture does not command a lamb meal outside the place YHWH chose, and it does not forbid a family from eating lamb. **Freedom, not commandment.** Others keep the evening simply with the bread and the cup, reading Exodus 12 and the Gospel accounts. Neither household is more holy than the other.

Away From the Land Is Not Away From Him

YHWH made provision in Torah for the one who could not be there. In Numbers 9:9-11, a man who was unclean or **on a journey far away** was not told to skip Passover. He was given a second Passover a month later. YHWH cared enough about his people keeping this day that he built in a way for those who were away. **Stated in the text.**

When the temple was destroyed and Judah was carried into Babylon, YHWH said of his scattered people, **yet I will be to them a sanctuary for a little while in the countries where they have come** (Ezekiel 11:16). Daniel had no temple, but he kept praying three times a day toward Jerusalem (Daniel 6:10). Hosea prophesied that Israel would

live many days without sacrifice and without altar, and afterward return and seek YHWH (Hosea 3:4-5). The scattered house is not cut off from the appointed times. It keeps what it can keep, with a heart turned toward him.

SECTION VI

Grafted In: Who Is Invited to Passover

> *When a stranger lives as a foreigner with you, and would like to keep the Passover to YHWH, let all his males be circumcised, and then let him come near and keep it. He shall be as one who is born in the land; but no uncircumcised person shall eat of it. One law shall be to him who is born at home, and to the stranger who lives as a foreigner among you.*
> **EXODUS 12:48-49**

From the first Passover, the stranger, the *ger* (H1616), could keep it. A mixed multitude came out of Egypt with Israel (Exodus 12:38), and YHWH gave one instruction for the native born and the stranger who joined himself to him. Numbers 9:14 repeats it for the Passover specifically. Paul says Gentiles who come to Messiah are grafted into the same olive tree (Romans 11:17-24), no longer strangers but fellow citizens of the household of Elohim (Ephesians 2:12-19).

THE QUESTION PEOPLE WILL ASK

Exodus 12:48 attaches circumcision to **eating** the Passover lamb. Anyone who quotes the one Torah verse should be honest about the verse before it.

Two things are true. First, the lamb cannot be sacrificed today (Deuteronomy 16:5-6), so no one, native or stranger, is eating the Passover sacrifice of Exodus 12. Second, Scripture also speaks of circumcision of the heart (Deuteronomy 10:16; 30:6; Romans 2:28-29; Colossians 2:11), and the apostles ruled that Gentiles are not saved by circumcision (Acts 15:1-11).

Conviction: at Kingdom Life we count circumcision among the instructions we walk in, never as a requirement for salvation. Salvation is by the blood of the Lamb, the same as it was on the doors in Egypt.

In the days of King Hezekiah, the king sent letters to all Israel and Judah, and to Ephraim and Manasseh in the north, inviting them to come and keep the Passover to YHWH (2 Chronicles 30:1). Many mocked, but some humbled themselves and came (30:10-11). Some had not cleansed themselves, and Hezekiah prayed, **may the good YHWH pardon everyone who sets his heart to seek Elohim**, and YHWH heard and healed the people (30:18-20). That is the heart of a Passover invitation: humble yourself and come.

SECTION VII

What We Leave Out and Why

Much of what people picture when they hear the word Passover comes from rabbinic tradition, not from Scripture: the printed Haggadah, the four cups, the cup set out for Elijah, the hidden piece of matzah, and the seder plate with the egg and the paste of fruit and nuts. Some of these grew up after the temple was destroyed in AD 70 as a replacement for the lamb.

We do not condemn anyone who sits at that table. But we do not teach it as YHWH's instruction, because it is not written. Yahshua warned against teaching the commandments of men as doctrine and setting aside the commandment of Elohim to keep a tradition (Mark 7:7-9). **Where Scripture speaks, we follow it. Where it is silent, we do not add a commandment.** What Scripture does name for the Passover table is unleavened bread and bitter herbs (Exodus 12:8; Numbers 9:11), the memorial and the telling to our children, and Yahshua's bread and cup.

SECTION VIII

The Blood and Forgiveness

Passover is a deliverance feast. Israel walked out of four hundred years of bondage on the strength of one night of blood. And every deliverance in Scripture begins in the same place: covered by the blood, set free by forgiveness.

In him we have our redemption through his blood, the forgiveness of our trespasses (Ephesians 1:7). Yahshua said of the cup, **this is my blood of the new covenant, which is poured out for many for the remission of sins** (Matthew 26:28). The blood that covered us is the same blood that requires us to cover others. The servant who was forgiven ten thousand talents and would not forgive a hundred denarii was handed over to the tormentors (Matthew 18:23-35).

> **BEFORE YOU COME TO THE TABLE**
>
> Do not bring Egypt with you. Before Passover evening, let go of the debt someone owes you. Pride holds the record. Humility tears it up.
>
> **Humility is the root of forgiveness, and forgiveness is the root of deliverance.** If you have been covered, you can afford to cover.

SECTION IX

Walking It Out

1. **Watch for the first month.** Mark the fourteenth day of Abib. At Kingdom Life we count the month from the sighted new moon; that is our conviction, since Torah does not spell out how the month is to be seen.
2. **Prepare your house.** Passover leads straight into the seven days of Unleavened Bread. Clear out the leaven before the fifteenth begins (see the Unleavened Bread handout).
3. **Settle accounts before sunset.** Forgive one specific debt and ask forgiveness for one specific wrong.
4. **Gather your household.** Read Exodus 12 out loud, then John 19. Let the children ask questions, and answer them with what YHWH did.
5. **Remember the Lamb.** Take the bread and the cup in memory of him, examining yourselves first.
6. **Set the table simply.** Unleavened bread and bitter herbs are the foods Scripture names. A lamb meal is your freedom, never a sacrifice.

7 **Invite someone.** Like Hezekiah, send the invitation. Someone in your life has never heard that this appointed time is for them too.

SECTION X

Cross Reference Index

Primary texts: Leviticus 23:4-5; Exodus 12:1-28; Deuteronomy 16:1-8; 1 Corinthians 5:7-8

The night in Egypt: Exodus 12:1-14, 21-28, 38, 43-51; Exodus 13:3-10, 14-16; Joshua 24:14; Ezekiel 20:7-8

The word pasach: Exodus 12:13, 23, 27; Isaiah 31:5

The Lamb: Isaiah 53:7; John 1:29, 36; 1 Peter 1:18-19; Revelation 5:6-12; Hebrews 9:11-14

Fulfillment at the cross: Exodus 12:46; Psalm 34:20; John 18:38; John 19:4-6, 14, 29, 31-36

The week and the supper: Matthew 12:40; Mark 16:1; Luke 23:54-56; John 13:1; John 18:28; Matthew 26:17-29; Mark 14:12-25; Luke 22:7-20; 1 Corinthians 11:23-29

Without the temple: Deuteronomy 12:5-14; Deuteronomy 16:5-6; Numbers 9:9-14; Ezekiel 11:16; Daniel 6:10; Hosea 3:4-5; Hebrews 9:12, 24-28

The stranger and the grafted in: Exodus 12:19, 38, 48-49; Numbers 9:14; 2 Chronicles 30:1-20; Romans 11:17-24; Ephesians 2:12-19

Circumcision of the heart: Deuteronomy 10:16; Deuteronomy 30:6; Romans 2:28-29; Colossians 2:11; Acts 15:1-11

Tradition and Scripture: Mark 7:6-9; Matthew 15:3-9

Blood and forgiveness: Matthew 26:28; Ephesians 1:7; Matthew 18:21-35; Colossians 1:13-14

NOTES

Personal Notes and Convictions

Kingdom Life Ministry
Restoring YHWH's design for marriage, family, forgiveness, and deliverance.

Walk in truth, walk in light. Shalom.